



Scanned, Not Necessarily Safe

A Belief Survey of the Fire-Drill Assembly-Point QR Check-In's Actual Use

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Background

Every scheduled fire drill now ends at a QR post staff and students scan before dispersing. The Safety and Wellbeing Office logs the scan as an aggregate compliance count. Little is known about what respondents think it is actually for.

Aims

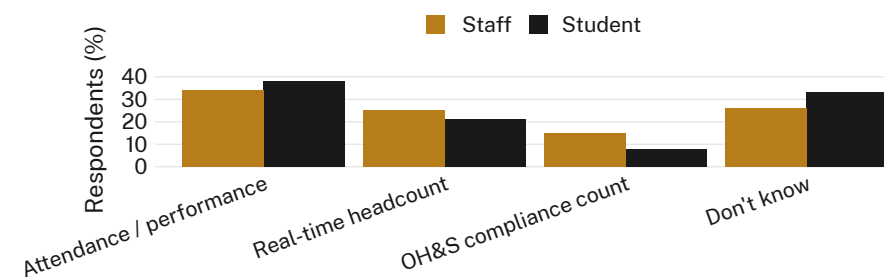
- Establish what staff and students believe the check-in is for
- Compare believed use against the Office's documented data schedule
- Test whether believed use predicts scan-and-return behaviour

Methods

- n = 246 · post-drill questionnaire · three buildings · one teaching term
- Free-text purpose-belief coding, checked against the Office's retention schedule
- Scan-and-return flagged via access-card re-entry within 4 minutes

Results

Most respondents could describe the scan mechanically; few could name its declared purpose. Believed disciplinary use tracked a higher rate of scan-and-return.



Only 11.2% of respondents (staff 15%, students 8%) named the Office's aggregate compliance count as the check-in's use; 59% named an individually attributed record the Office does not keep (n = 246, June–July 2026).

Discussion & conclusions

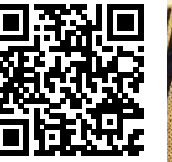
Built to count who left the building; read by most as a record of who they are. That reading does not raise compliance — respondents who named a disciplinary use showed triple the scan-and-return rate of those who named the actual compliance count. Next: whether restating the check-in's declared purpose changes what it is scanned for is untested.

References

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2. Glavin, P., Bierman, A., & Schieman, S. (2024). Private eyes, they see your every move: Workplace surveillance and worker well-being. Social Currents, 11(4), 327–345. doi:10.1177/23294965241228874
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Ethics ref 2026/118; scan-and-return matched via access-card timestamps already logged for building security, not collected for this study.

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“Everyone could describe the scan.
Almost no one could say what it’s for.”

246 respondents, eight drills, one term — 11% named the Office's actual declared use.